

WAR AND PEACE

TURNING POINT: Nehru in a forward area in the North-east Frontier

<< **REWIND**



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The ditty "*Hindi Chini bhai bhai*" became "*Hindi Chini bye bye*". Attacking India in October, China quickly snapped up Indian positions in Ladakh and NEFA, aided by a complete collapse of military leadership. A shattered Jawaharlal Nehru called it a "deliberate cold-blooded decision". The second Chinese offensive in November saw young men pouring into the army. Though China declared a unilateral ceasefire, 1,383 Indian soldiers were killed, 3,968 were taken prisoners and 1,696 were missing. M.J. Akbar wrote in *India: The Siege Within*, "It was as if suddenly the adolescence was over and the country had to mature through a most painful crisis. In those 10 days when it seemed as if the Chinese would march across the Himalayas or seep through Assam capturing Guwahati, there was the realisation that freedom and nationhood could not be taken casually."

FIRST CUT

- The Income Tax Act, 1961, came into force on April 1.
- The Indian National Committee on Space Research was set up by Vikram Sarabhai.

RICHARD B. RUSSELL who opposed American arms supply to India

"Indians put up a disgraceful exhibition in being driven out of impregnable strongholds in the border mountains."